

Brockenhurst overflight — working-group briefing

A short, honest brief to help the group build a case to Bournemouth Airport:

(1) that there is a low-flying problem over Brockenhurst, and (2) a credible proposal to route arrivals to one side of the village, over open forest.

Aim 1 — Show there is a problem (this part is strong)

We have three years of **public flight data** (2023–2025) taken from the aircraft's **own GPS/ADS-B broadcasts** — independent of the airport. Headlines:

- **Brockenhurst sits directly under the runway-26 approach.** ~76% of airliner arrivals come in over the village (the rest land the other way, on runway 08, and miss it). The track map shows a clear hotspot straight through the village.
- **They're lower than a quiet descent would put them.** A proper "glide-down" continuous descent would be ~**3,100 ft** over Brockenhurst. Airliners average ~**2,800 ft**, and **66% → 73% → 74%** (2023→2025) are **below** the quiet-descent line — and the average is **falling** each year.
- **They level off low instead of gliding.** A continuous descent has no level flight. We can see arrivals **levelling off** over the village — the times a plane flies level it must add engine power, which is the noise. Level-offs over the village rose **63 → 95 → 157** a year.
- **Nights are getting worse.** Night airliners over Brockenhurst rose **263 → 332 → 583**; those below the 2,000 ft minimum went **0 → 2 → 7**.
- **It's the airport's own standard we're measuring against.** Bournemouth's published rules (UK AIP, EGHH AD 2.21) require a "continuous descent... at all times," staying "as high an altitude as practical," joining the approach "without level flight" — and a **night rule** (2130-0630): establish no closer than **8 miles / not below 2,500 ft**.

Bring to the meeting / the airport: the 2-page brief PDF, the year-by-year descent graph, the night analytics dashboard, the track map, and the single worked example (Jet2, 12 Oct 2025, levelling at ~2,050 ft over the village at 23:28). Everything is reproducible and sourced.

Aim 2 — Propose an alternative route (frame this carefully)

The instinct — "route the planes north or south of the village, over open forest" — is sound, **but it must be framed correctly or it will be dismissed**. There are two separate levers; propose **both**, because one is quick and free.

Lever A — Height (quick, cheap, no airspace change)

Ask the airport to **actually deliver the continuous descent its own rules** already require: **keep arrivals higher and descending steadily (on/above the**

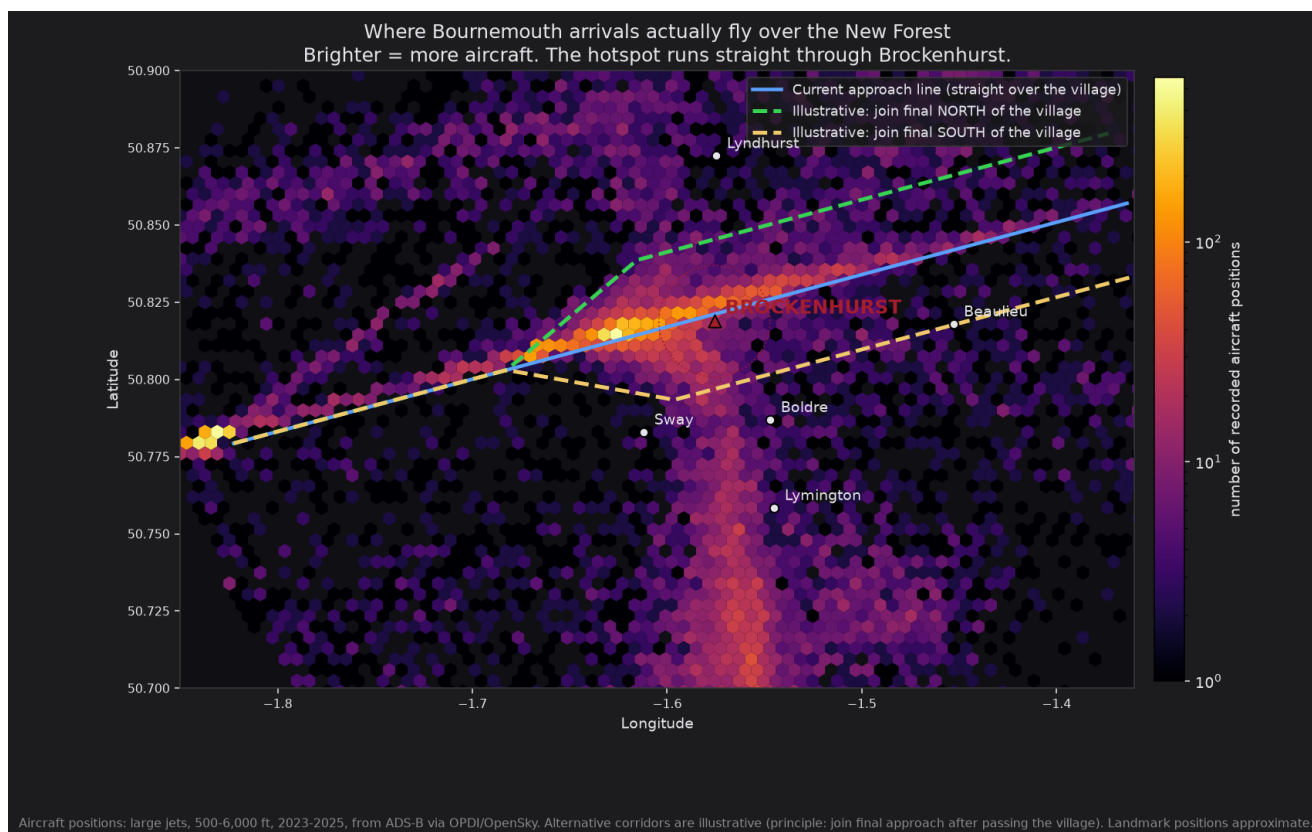
~3° path, ~3,000 ft over Brockenhurst) and **stop the low level-offs**. This needs **no airspace change** — it's ATC technique and airline engagement, using the airport's own published policy. Higher + continuous = quieter over the village, starting now.

Lever B — Lateral routing (bigger, needs a formal process)

Key technical fact to get right: **the final ~5 miles cannot be moved** — it has to line up with the runway (that's the ILS). **But Brockenhurst is ~10 miles out, and out there aircraft do not have to be on the straight extended centreline**. They can be routed to **join the final approach north or south of the village, over open forest, then turn onto the runway line closer in**. Modern satellite-based approaches (RNAV/RNP) make such a "join after the village" path precisely designable. Our track map already shows many aircraft join from wider out — the ask is to make that the **standard**, on a defined corridor that avoids the village.

Be honest about these points (they protect your credibility):

- You're **not** asking to move the runway or the final approach — only the joining path further out.
- A lateral change is a formal **CAA Airspace Change Proposal (process CAP1616)**, led by the airport / its air-traffic provider (NATS). It takes time and includes public consultation — residents can **request it and must be consulted**.
- **Don't pre-pick north vs south**. Each needs a check of who lives underneath and other constraints (Southampton's airspace to the north-east may make one side easier). Ask the airport/NATS to **assess both** and choose the lower-impact option — offer to help identify the quietest corridor.



Likely airport push-back → your answer

- "It's standard / safe / constrained by Southampton airspace." → Agreed there are constraints, but **Lever A needs no airspace change at all**, and lateral joins are routinely designed elsewhere within similar constraints.
 - "2,000–2,500 ft is a normal approach height." → It's **below** their own continuous-descent expectation; the real issue is **level flight**, and it's **getting worse**.
 - "You only capture some flights." → **97%** of arrivals are tracked; the precise-height sample is representative and unbiased, so our **counts are minimums — the true numbers are higher**.
 - "It's just wind / one-offs." → It's a **consistent, three-year, worsening** pattern, **not isolated flights**.
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Who to approach & the process

- **Bournemouth Airport** — Environmental / Noise team, and the **Airport Consultative Committee (community-representation body)**. **Ask for Brockenhurst representation**, and for the airport's **own CDA-compliance and WebTrak data**.
- **NATS / the airport's air-traffic provider** — for procedure/airspace design.
- **CAA** — owns the **CAP1616** airspace-change process (for Lever B).
- **New Forest National Park Authority** — a strong statutory ally (its purpose is to conserve the Park); overflight of a National Park is a powerful hook. Also the **parish/town council**, **local district council**, and the **MP**.

Suggested concrete asks

1. Airport to **publish its runway-26 CDA-compliance** and commit to improving it (higher, continuous, no level-offs) — near-term, no airspace change.
2. Airport/NATS to run a **feasibility study of an RNAV join** that keeps runway-26 arrivals north **or** south of Brockenhurst.
3. **Enforce the existing night rule** (2,500 ft / 8 miles) and review night movements.
4. **Brockenhurst seat** on the Airport Consultative Committee.

Next steps for the group (agree tomorrow)

- Nominate a **lead** and a **note-taker / data owner**.
 - Agree a **one-page ask** (the four points above).
 - Line up **allies**: National Park Authority, parish council, MP.
 - Request a **meeting with the airport + a place at the Consultative Committee**.
 - Keep the **data pack** current (this repo regenerates every chart on demand).
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Prepared from public data; not affiliated with the airport. Sources and method: DATA_AND_DEFINITIONS.md and METHODOLOGY.md. The alternative corridors on the map are illustrative — they show the principle, not an engineered route.